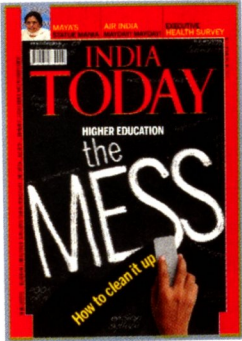


How to Clean the Mess

JULY 13, 2009

Higher education in India is in a big mess and unless drastic steps are taken, the country will lose out not only in terms of growth but also in its quest to emerge as a major world power.



“The Government must give directions and set up a system to deal with dubious institutions that are fleecing students and parents of their money by offering bogus courses.”

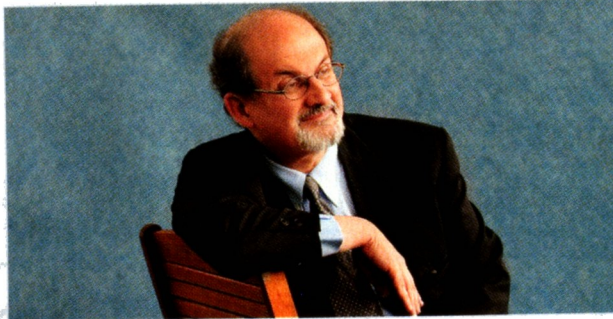
VINOD C. DIXIT, *Ahmedabad*

Coming Clean

Rather than producing ordinary graduates on a massive scale, our education system should be revamped in a way that it becomes more job-specific (“How to Clean the Mess”, July 13). Excellence comes to the fore only and if only we put an end to the reservation system based on caste. A lot of thought needs to be put into this without any votebank considerations.

GANTI MAHAPATRUNI RAMA RAO, *via www.indiatoday.in*

The time has come for decision makers from all parties to brainstorm and draw a blueprint for the improvement of higher education with an eight to 10 years implementation plan. While opening up higher education to the private sector, the



What Lies Beneath

I read S. Prasannarajan's review of two books on Salman Rushdie (“Satanic Temptations”, June 22). Non-Muslim writers and observers fail to see why the Muslim community reacts strongly to any denigration of the Holy Prophet. Muslims do not object to any academic analysis of Islam or its laws or history. But Rushdie, with his blasphemous initiative, opened the doors, on one hand, for Islamophobia in the West, culminating in the Danish cartoons and, on the other, for the Muslim rage in ‘war against civilisation’. I don't endorse the view that what has been described as jihad in recent times has religious roots. It has political roots, particularly in foreign occupation of Muslim states, exploitation of their resources and repression of their people. The tension between the West and the Islamic world will rise if raging Islamophobia widens the gulf.

SYED SHAHABUDDIN, *Former member of Parliament, Delhi*

Government should have a regulatory body to provide the necessary guidelines and regulate the syllabus, fee structure, faculty quality and infrastructure. With a single regulatory body in place, the Government can ensure quality education. BHASKAR BHATTACHARYA, *Mumbai*

Distress Call

It would be absolutely immoral on the part of the Indian Government to bail out Air India with public funds (“Mayday! Mayday!”, July 13). According to a recent report, Air India pays huge salaries to its employees. The pilots in the international sector are paid up to \$15,000 every month. The public has every right to ask the Government why is it

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